Lake Powell and Lake Mead Historical and Current Reservoir Data

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Overview

This is an R Markdown document. The document generates plots for Lake Powell and Lake Mead:

1. Annual Lake Powell Release Compared to 7.5 and 8.23 Targets

Data wrangling strategy

1. Import the reservoir elevation-volume curves.
2. Import Daily, Monthly, and Annual Lake Powell and Lake Mead data from the Reclamation's HydroData Web portal https://www.usbr.gov/uc/water/hydrodata/reservoir_data/site_map.html
3. Filter the reservoir data for the appropriate variables/fields.

This is a beginning R-programming effort! There could be lurking bugs or basic coding errors that I am not even aware of. Please report bugs/feedback to me (contact info below)

Requested Citation

David E. Rosenberg (2026), "Lake Powell and Lake Mead Historical and Current Reservoir Data." Utah State University. Logan, Utah. https://github.com/dzeke/ColoradoRiverCollaborate/tree/main/HistoricalCurrentReservoirData.

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Table 1: Current Storage and Elevations

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[1] "Reservoir Data on: October 27 , 2026"
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ResName	Storage	Pool Elevation
Lake Powell	5.84	3530.09
Lake Mead	6.86	1038.29

Figure 1: Lake Powell Storage and Elevation over Time in relation to Consequences.



Figure 2: Lake Mead Storage and Elevation over Time and Consequences.

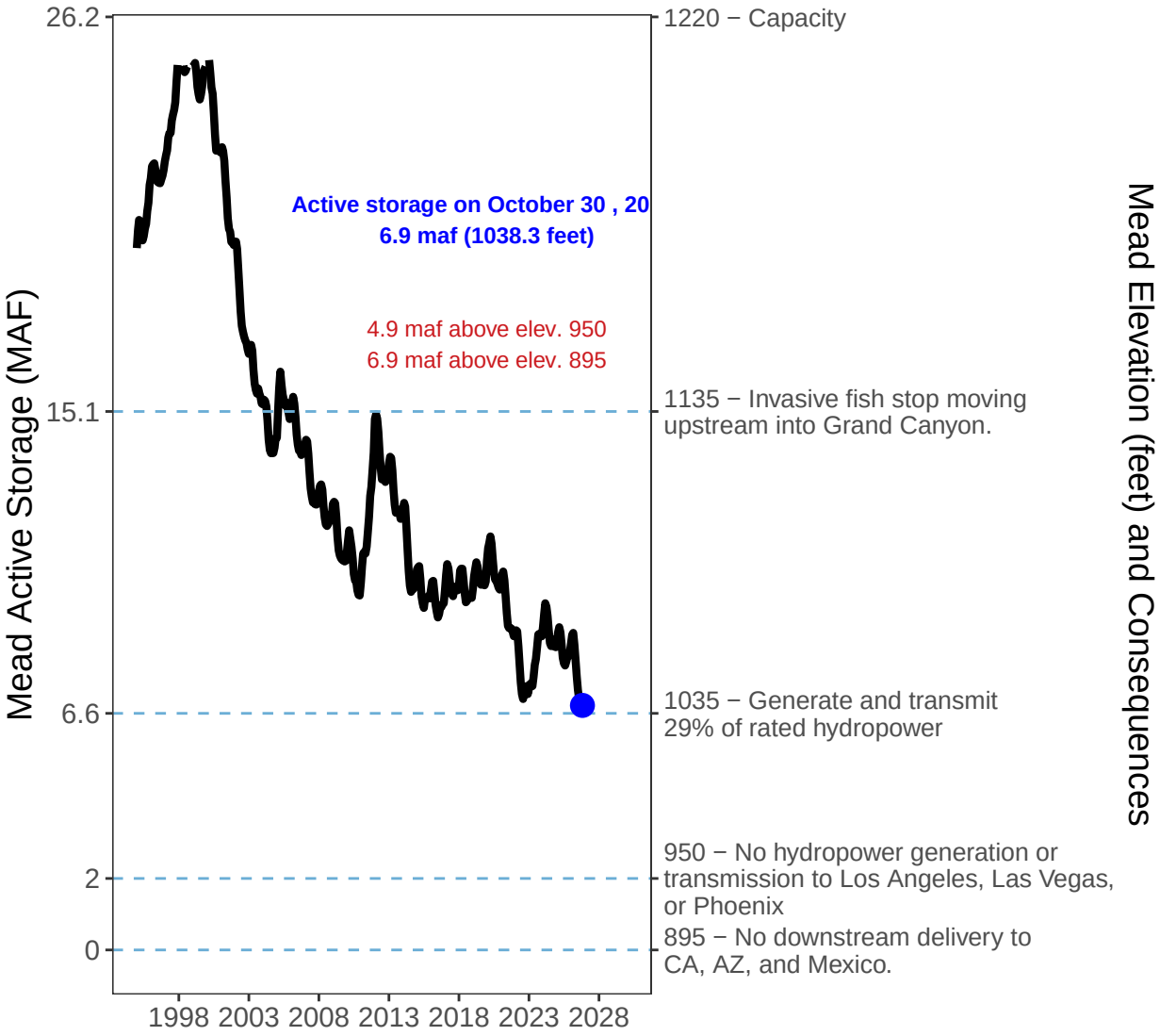


Figure 4: Lake Powell Minimum Drawdown and Catastrophic Elevations - Daily Data

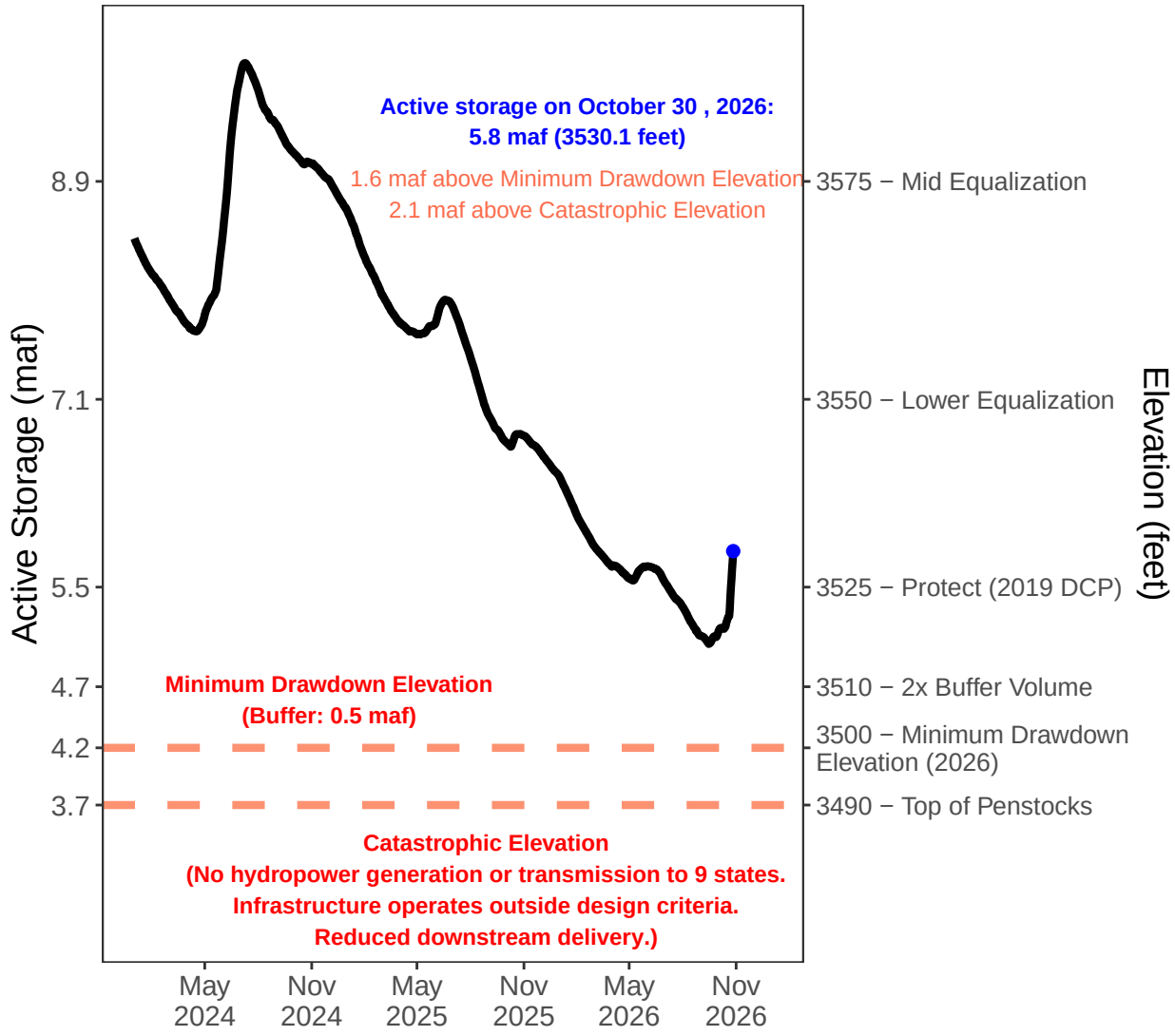


Figure AA: Lake Powell, Lake Mead, and Combined Storage

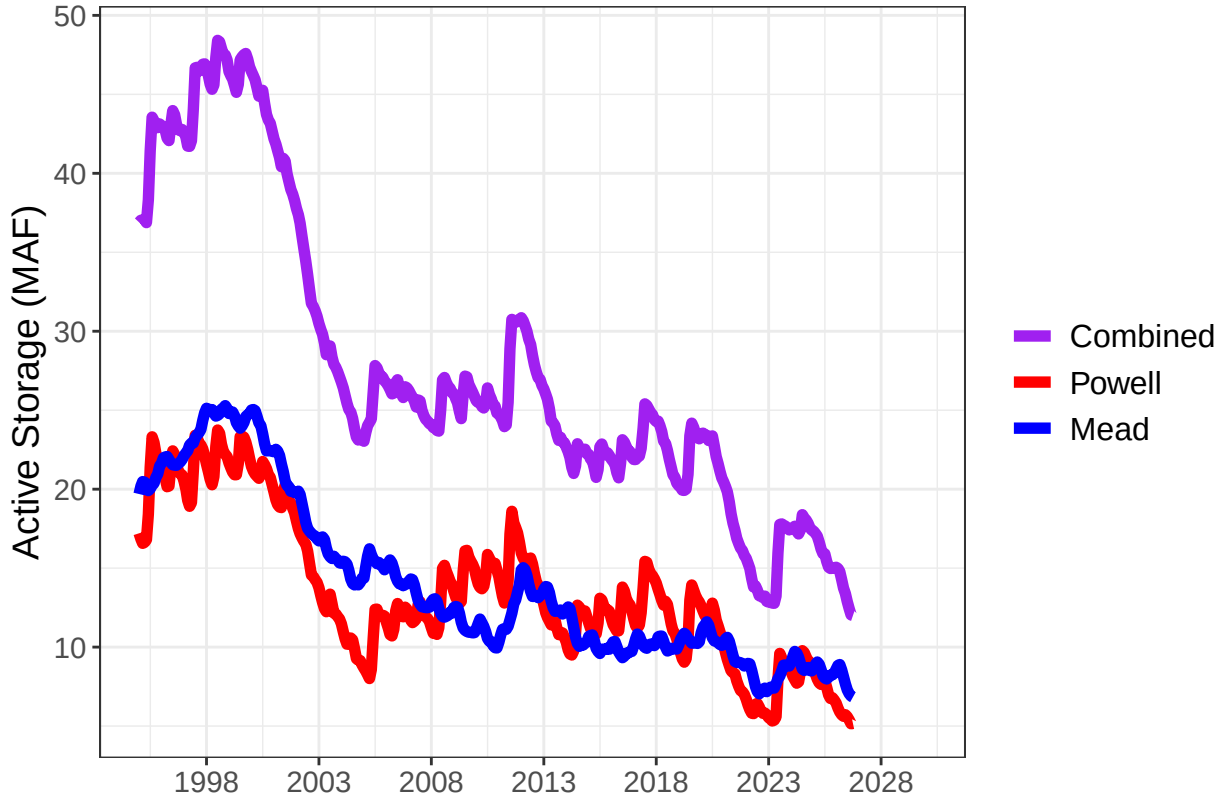


Figure BB: Lake Powell Daily Inflow and Release.

Total volumes in legend are water year to date.

